



Earl Spencer's fury at estranged wife over claim he had affair and ended marriage by text



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PM'S 'REWARD FOR FAILURE' AS SADIQ KHAN IS KNIGHTED

London Mayor row risks overshadowing New Year Honours

By Vanessa Allen, Claire Ellicott and Andy Jehring

SADIQ Khan has been handed a knighthood in the New Year Honours – prompting furious claims of a 'reward for failure'.

The Mayor of London, a former Labour MP, received the gong in the first batch of appointments made since Keir Starmer entered Downing Street.

Leading Tories pointed to his 'track record of failure' in the capital, including over tackling knife crime and dramatic hikes in council tax, congestion charges and emissions levies.

The furore came as hundreds of other honours were awarded to charity workers and selfless volunteers in a New Year Honours list intended to recognise 'unsung heroes'.

There were also accolades for dozens of sports stars and celebrities, including knighthoods for former England football manager Gareth Southgate and actor Stephen Fry.

Other notable recipients included authors Dame Jacqueline Wilson and Sir Kazuo Ishiguro, gardener Alan Titchmarsh and actresses Sarah Lancashire and Carey Mulligan. Several of Team GB's Olympians and Paralympians



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